

## LED phosphor lights to drive global phosphor market

For decades, phosphors have been used for fluorescent lighting. With the growing usage of LEDs across the globe due to their energy-efficient operations, demand for innovative phosphor solutions has also increased. As countries are shifting their focus towards LEDs due to their longer life, lesser power consumption and increased efficiency, the global LED phosphor market is witnessing stupendous growth.

However, development of new phosphor solutions for LED lights brings in a host of challenges, such as unpleasant coolness or warmth, sub-standard colour rendering as compared to conventional bulbs and changes in LED colour temperature with viewing angle.

Another challenge is the influx of new patents in the market, which is leading to a war for intellectual property right between several players.

## India 3D printer market to reach US\$ 79 million by 2021

According to a latest 3D printer report, India 3D printer market is projected to cross US\$ 79 million by 2021. In India's 3D printer market, automotive application accounted for majority of the revenue share. Among all 3D printing technologies, FDM technology based 3D printers dominate the overall market. Low cost and ease of availability of these printers have led to the majority of market revenues.

3D printing is the next-generation printing technology in additive manufacturing. This technology is in its nascent stage in majority of the countries. However, with the expiry of key patents, low cost of production, increasing awareness and penetration, and advancements in material research, 3D printer market is expected to witness tremendous growth.

## In Focus

### Dell promotes P. Krishnakumar to VP - consumer and small business

Technology provider Dell has promoted P. Krishnakumar to VP - consumer and small business. In this role, he will continue to focus on driving strong customer growth and revenue performance for consumer and small businesses in India.

### Sunil Nayyar to lead Sony consumer electronics business in the USA

Sony Corp. has ascended its head

of sales for Indian operations, Sunil Nayyar, to lead its consumer electronics business in the USA, which is its largest market.

### Akshay Dhoot to take over Videocon's tech wing

Videocon, in an attempt to take the battle straight to its Japanese and Korean rivals, has made Akshay Dhoot (son of Venugopal Dhoot, group chairman) as group technology head. He has readied a range of innovative products based on disruptive technologies.

In industrial applications, 3D printer market faces major challenge from CNC machines, which cost much less than 3D printers in India, thus increasing reluctance among consumers to opt for 3D printers.

## EMC in Chhattisgarh

Government of Chhattisgarh, in order to promote electronics manufacturing in the state, has proposed an electronics manufacturing cluster (EMC) near Raipur.

The proposed EMC in Naya Raipur (New Raipur), new capital city that is expected to emerge as India's first smart city, is aimed at providing one-stop integrated facilities with manufacturing support, welfare and common infrastructure facilities to prospective electronics manufacturing industries. The EMC aims to house a world-class ecosystem for electronics manufacturing industries.

## Maharashtra government to abolish local body tax

Maharashtra government has decided to abolish local body tax (LBT), effective August 1, 2015. In order to compensate the trading community, it has also been decided that value added tax (VAT) rate will be increased.

LBT was introduced by the previ-

ous Congress-NCP government with an objective to replace Octroi. But, Octroi was replaced in all municipal corporations in Maharashtra, except Mumbai.

The electronics trading community in Maharashtra believes that goods and services tax (GST) can set off the losses that government bodies incur by abolishing LBT. Traders, distributors and channel partners have unanimously supported this move as they feel it will simplify the tax structure and turn India into one large common market by rationalising the supply chain.

## India, Taiwan to jointly boost investment

India Electronics and Semiconductor Association (IESA) has signed an MoU with Taiwan Electrical and Electronic Manufacturers' Association (TEEMA) to extend bilateral investment ties for technology and knowledge transfer and manufacturing opportunities, in line with government's Make in India drive.

The partnership will facilitate members from both countries visiting each other's important industrial leaders, institutions and organisations, and organise trade meetings to help members understand international trade practices. The association will